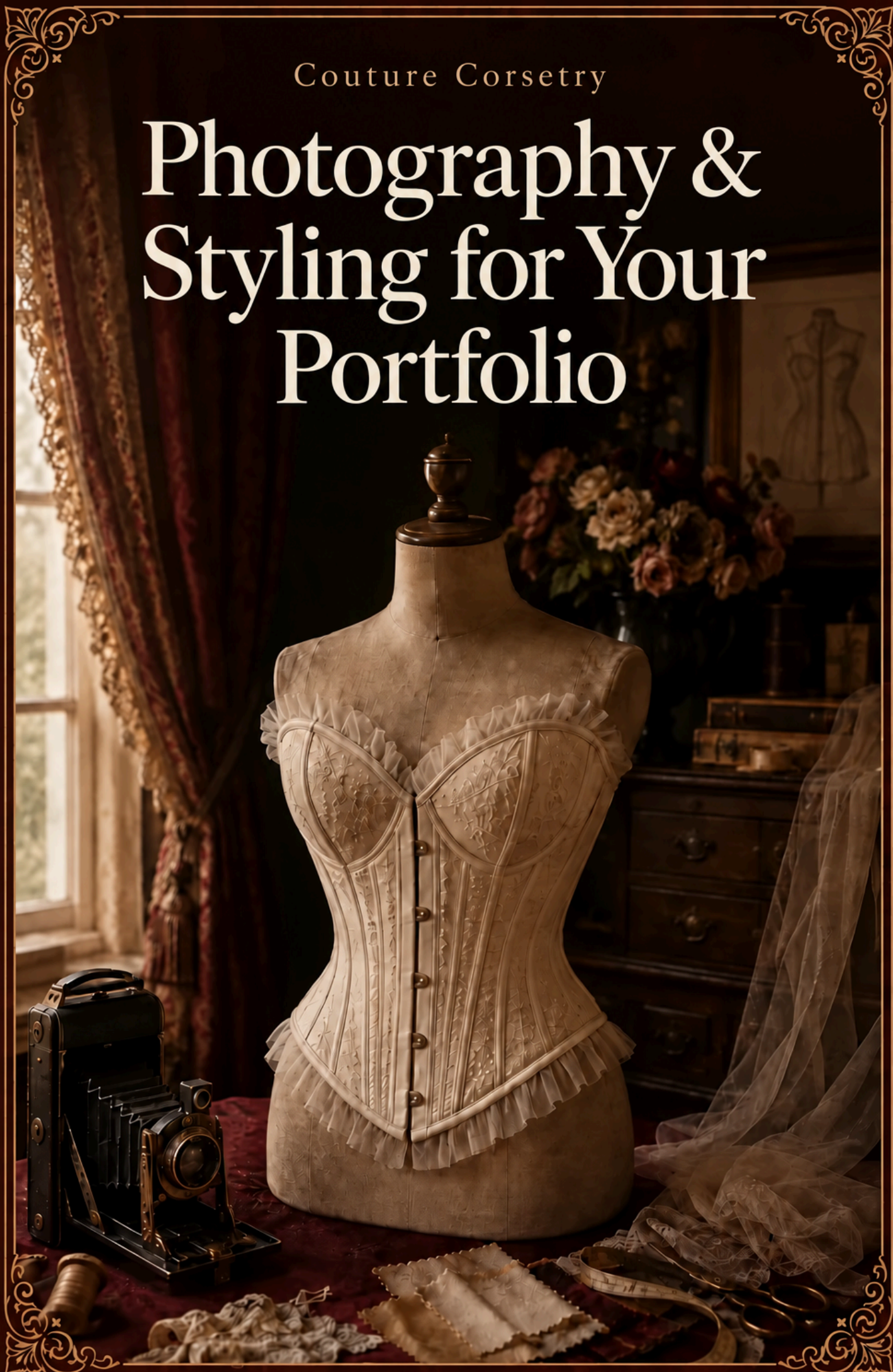


Couture Corsetry

Photography & Styling for Your Portfolio



Photography & Styling for Your Portfolio

So the shape, texture and finishing of your corset come across when you share it online. With your phone and what you already have at home.

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1 · What a good corset photo needs to show

People looking at your work on their phone decide in seconds. Each photo has to answer one question:

The photo shows...	...and answers
The full silhouette	How does it look on?
The back with the lacing	How does it fasten?
Close-up details	Is it well made?
The garment as part of an outfit	What do I wear it with?

2 · Light: the window is your best studio

- 1 Shoot in daylight, next to a large window, without direct sun.
- 2 Place the garment side-on to the window (at 45°): side light brings out the seams and the shape of the panels.
- 3 On the side away from the window, prop up a white card or white cloth: it bounces the light back and softens the shadows.
- 4 Turn off the room lights: mixing window light with lamps changes the colors.
- 5 If there is direct sun, hang a thin white curtain or some tulle over the window to soften it.

Shiny fabric (satin). If you get very strong white reflections, move the garment away from the window or turn it a few degrees until the sheen looks soft.

3 · Background and space

- ☐ A plain, neutral background: a light wall, linen fabric or a large sheet of card.
 - ☐ The same background for every photo in a collection: that way your portfolio looks consistent.
 - ☐ Nothing around it: clear furniture, cables and objects out of the frame.
 - ☐ If you want a background with more character (wood, dark velvet), use it only for detail or outfit shots.
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4 · Dress form or person

Dress form

Ideal for showing the construction. Choose one close to the pattern size, lace it firmly and settle the corset so the waist sits straight. A dress form on a stand at a person's chest height gives more natural photos.

Person

Shows how it looks on the body and in movement. Always ask permission before posting and agree which photos go up. Upright posture, relaxed shoulders, arms slightly away from the body so the waist shows.

5 · The 8 photos for every piece

- 1 **Full front**, at the height of the middle of the corset.
- 2 **Back** with neat lacing.
- 3 **Profile**: shows the curve of the waist and hip.
- 4 **Three-quarter view**: the most flattering shot for your cover image.
- 5 **Detail of the busk** or the front closure.
- 6 **Detail of the eyelets** and the lacing.
- 7 **Detail of the binding** and of a seam with a boning channel.
- 8 **Inside**: neat work on the inside sells too.

Camera height. Always at the height of the middle of the garment and level. If you tilt it down or up, the waist gets distorted in the photo.

6 · Setting up your phone

Setting	Recommendation
Lens	Clean it before you start.
Zoom	Use the standard lens (1x) or 2x from a little further away. The wide angle distorts.
Focus and exposure	Tap the garment on the screen and lower the exposure a little if the light areas look “blown out”.
Flash	Off.
Stability	Rest the phone on something or use a tripod and the 3-second timer.
Format	Portrait for social media; leave space around it so you can crop.

7 · Styling: putting the outfit together

- ☐ Pair the corset with a simple piece that lets it shine: a white shirt, a pencil skirt, high-waisted pants.
 - ☐ For an evening look, add a long tulle or satin skirt in the same shade.
 - ☐ Show lingerie as a set: bra and briefs in the same fabric as the corset or bodysuit.
 - ☐ Minimal accessories: an earring, gloves, a ribbon. Nothing that covers the waist.
 - ☐ Press everything that appears in the photo, not just the corset.
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8 · Simple, consistent editing

- 1 Use your phone’s photo app or a free editing app.
 - 2 Crop straight and centered.
 - 3 Adjust only light, contrast and whites. Make sure the fabric color is true to life.
 - 4 Save those settings and apply them the same way to every photo from the same session.
 - 5 Never change the shape of the garment or slim the waist in editing: your client has to receive what she saw.
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9 · Building your portfolio

- ☐ One folder per garment with its 8 photos and the name of the pattern you used.
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- ☐ Choose your best 9 to 12 photos for your main showcase: a variety of styles with one consistent look.
- ☐ Write under each piece: type of corset, fabrics, closure and whether it is made to measure.
- ☐ Add process photos (toile, fitting, details): they show the craft behind the garment.
- ☐ Update it every time you finish a new piece.

Next step

Choose your most recent finished garment, prepare it with the Finishing Checklist and do the 8-photo session next to a window. With that first folder you already have the start of your portfolio.